Informed Consent Agreement for Participation in a Research Study

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Title of Research Study: Feynman AI IQP

Introduction
You are being asked to participate in a research study. Before you agree, however, you must be fully informed about the purpose of the study, the procedures to be followed, and any benefits, risks or discomfort that you may experience as a result of your participation. This form presents information about the study so that you may make a fully informed decision regarding your participation.

Purpose of the study:
This study will examine how an artificial intelligence (AI) learning tool can support students in understanding academic concepts. The tool uses the Feynman Technique, in which learners explain a topic in their own words to identify gaps in their understanding. It asks follow-up questions and provides feedback to help students clarify their reasoning. The study will gather feedback about participants' experiences to guide improvements to the tool and explore its usefulness for learning.

Procedures to be followed:
You will be asked to try the Feynman AI learning tool by explaining an academic concept in your own words and interacting with its questions and feedback. You will then be asked to provide feedback about your experience. The tool is being evaluated as part of this research study.

Risks to study participants:
Possible discomforts include frustration or embarrassment when explaining a topic or encountering gaps in understanding. The AI tool may provide inaccurate or confusing feedback. Collection of study information may also involve a risk of unintended disclosure of private information.

Benefits to research participants and others:
You may gain practice explaining academic concepts and recognizing gaps in your understanding. Improvement in learning is not guaranteed. Your feedback may help the research team improve the tool and understand how AI can support learning.

Record keeping and confidentiality:

Records of your participation in this study will be held confidential so far as permitted by law. However, the study investigators, the sponsor or its designee and, under certain circumstances, the Worcester Polytechnic Institute Institutional Review Board (WPI IRB) will be able to inspect and have access to confidential data that identify you by name. Any publication or presentation of the data will not identify you.

Compensation or treatment in the event of injury:
"You do not give up any of your legal rights by signing this statement.

For more information about this research or about the rights of research participants, or in case of research-related injury, contact:

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Your participation in this research is voluntary. Your refusal to participate will not result in any penalty to you or any loss of benefits to which you may otherwise be entitled. You may decide to stop participating in the research at any time without penalty or loss of other benefits. The project investigators retain the right to cancel or postpone the experimental procedures at any time they see fit.

By signing below, you acknowledge that you have been informed about and consent to be a participant in the study described above. Make sure that your questions are answered to your satisfaction before signing. You are entitled to retain a copy of this consent agreement.

_____ Date: _____
Study Participant Signature

_____
Study Participant Name (Please print)

_____ Date: _____
Signature of Person who explained this study